

DMC welcome letter

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Dear participants,

Welcome to “Tales of Defiance to Mind Control in the Modern Age”, or “DMC” for short. I am looking forward to our learning together. I welcome your arguments, alternatives, and even complaints.

We meet on Monday, Period 2 (11:10 am to 12:35 pm), in person at 51 Sawyer Road, Room ?. Classes meet on November 2, 9, 16, 23, and 30.

Please feel free to contact me at axelrod@alumni.princeton.edu with comments, questions, requests for clarification or help, or to let me know if you will be late or absent for a class.

So that I can verify that all email addresses work and we can start getting to know one another, please reply to this note with a brief email that includes your name, the town where you live, what sparked your interest in taking this class, and any background information you would like to share. If you are comfortable doing so, please include a picture of yourself to help me connect faces with names. Please also indicate which information from your response you authorize me to share with the class. I will combine the authorized information into a single email, which I plan to send to the class on November 1.

For each of the first four weeks, we will focus on a different “Tales of Defiance to Mind Control”. The final week will be devoted to discussion of the arc of all four stories as a whole.

Website

Here is a link to: [the course website](#). Parts of the website are under construction, but all the materials needed to prepare for Week 1 are available now. With the exception of personal information about students, such as the information in the “single email” mentioned above, all class materials will be accessible from the website. I will also send all essential material by email. The website has a header and a page that appears in a frame below the header. The header has a dropdown box in the upper left that allows one to select the page that appears in the frame below the header. When I email links to course website pages, I will send links to the standalone pages, without the course header.

An Arc of Stories and Lenses

Each of the four stories we will explore could be the basis of one or more full courses. Combining them means we won’t be able to cover the individual stories in great depth, but it will allow us to see an example of what I call *an* arc of dystopian stories. For each story, I will suggest a tool or “lens” we can use to examine it. These lenses are intended to foster thinking and discussion, not to create a barrier of abstraction.

Week 1 Homework

The homework to prepare for our first class is the following, which is copied from the [Week1 page](#). I have attached PDF version of the Week1, Syllabus, Preface, and Notes on *Notes from Underground* pages.

- Read the [Course Syllabus](#)
- Read the [Preface to the Course](#), which consists of sections:
 1. Genesis of the Course: Getting Perspective on Mind Control
 2. Shaping the Container
 3. What We Will Be Exploring
 4. An Arc of Stories and Lenses
 - You may delay reading the parts on the tales for weeks 2, 3, and 4, which will be repeated as part of the notes on the tale of the week.
- Read the [Notes on *Notes from Underground*](#).
 - This contains a section titled “Tale 1: Notes from the Underground”, which is an exact repeat of the part by that name under section 4 of the preface.
- Watch “Notes from the Underground”, one man show starring Larry Cedar, free on YouTube.



- Here are quotes and questions to think about to guide your reflection on the show:
 - Quote 1: At XXX, YYY says ...
“To be a hero or to grovel in the mud - there was nothing in between.”
 - Question 1: What is ... ?

I look forward to hearing from you and seeing you in class,
Scott Axelrod